

Monday, 21 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

22° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 12°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

20° 12°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 Earl Spencer, Princess Diana's brother, says the media's treatment of Prince Harry and Meghan echoes what his sister endured.**

He described the press coverage as a "cancerous influence" and recalled seeing Diana cry "tears of despair" over the constant interest in her life.

ROYALS · UK

- 2 Residents in Folkestone have been evacuated from their homes due to fears a hotel fire has weakened the building's structure.**

Safety inspectors raised concerns about the Grand Burstin Hotel after the blaze. People living nearby have been relocated as a precaution.

SAFETY · UK

- 3 The Liberal Democrats are calling for an immediate 10p cut to fuel duty to help struggling households.**

Sir Ed Davey blamed global events for pushing up fuel prices, arguing that the government needs to act now to ease the burden on drivers.

POLITICS · UK

- 4 Experts are warning that deadly new drugs are making Scotland's fight against addiction even harder.**

The introduction of potent new substances is exacerbating an already critical public health crisis. Authorities are grappling with how to respond to the escalating danger.

HEALTH · UK

- 5 A man has been re-arrested after the remains of missing mother-of-three Joanne Sheen were found.**

Her remains were discovered almost seven years after she disappeared. Police are continuing their investigation into the circumstances of her death.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **Strictly Come Dancing is back on our screens, with a new hosting trio and the celebrity pairings revealed!**

Emma Willis, Josh Widdicombe, and Johannes Radebe are taking over from Tess Daly and Claudia Winkleman. Viewers will be keen to see how the new dynamic works.

ON AIR – Are you excited about the new Strictly hosts? Who's your favourite celeb pairing this year?

TV · TONIGHT

2 **A new wave of queens are ready to snatch the crown as RuPaul's Drag Race UK returns for its eighth series.**

These contestants grew up watching the hit reality show, and now it's their turn to compete. Expect fierce competition and fabulous looks.

ON AIR – Are you a Drag Race fan? Who are you rooting for this series?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Welsh actor Matthew Rhys made history at the Emmy Awards, becoming the first person to win two lead acting prizes in one night!**

His sister expressed her immense pride in his achievement. Rhys described the experience as "surreal" during an interview.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Matthew Rhys role? Have you seen the shows he won for?

AWARDS · THIS WEEKEND

4 **Unheard Oasis recordings, valued at £1.6 million, are now up for sale, having been hidden for two decades!**

The tapes have been in the possession of a former sound engineer's family. This discovery is sure to excite fans of the iconic band.

ON AIR – Would you pay a fortune for unheard Oasis tracks? What's your favourite Oasis song?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **Actress Daisy Edgar-Jones reveals she tries to 'bury her emotion' when it comes to love, much like her new character.**

She's currently starring in a new adaptation of Sense and Sensibility. Daisy says she sees a lot of herself in the role.

ON AIR – Do you relate to burying your emotions in love? What's your favourite Jane Austen adaptation?

FILM · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City are heading into the international break in jubilant mood after a perfect 24 hours on the pitch.**

They've put pressure on Arsenal at the top of the Premier League. It's been a fantastic weekend for Pep Guardiola's side.

ON AIR – Can anyone stop Manchester City this season? Who do you think will win the Premier League?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Rangers are looking like a team with a clear direction, while Celtic appear to be lost after the Old Firm derby.**

Rangers repeated their League Cup win over Celtic in the first league game of the season. Derek McInnes's influence is clearly starting to show.

ON AIR – What do you make of the Old Firm rivalry this season? Can Celtic turn things around?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Brighton have cruised past Arsenal, ending the champions' perfect start to the Premier League season!**

Brighton secured a dominant 3-0 victory, inflicting Arsenal's first defeat. It was a stunning performance from the Seagulls.

ON AIR – Were you surprised by Brighton's win over Arsenal? What does this mean for the title race?
FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Middlesex have won the One Day Cup final, thanks to a century and four wickets from Saskia Horley!**

Horley's incredible all-round performance helped Middlesex beat Glamorgan in the League Two final in Bristol. It was a thrilling match.

ON AIR – What an incredible individual performance! Do you think we'll see more all-rounders like Horley?
CRICKET · UK

5 **Great Britain have qualified for the Davis Cup Finals after a dominant performance against Ecuador!**

Henry Patten and Neal Skupski secured an unassailable 3-0 lead with a doubles win. It's a fantastic achievement for the team.

ON AIR – Are you following the Davis Cup? How far do you think GB can go in the Finals?
TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners across the UK are finding joy in 'miniature gardening', creating tiny landscapes in pots and containers.**
This charming trend involves cultivating small plants, tiny trees, and even miniature garden ornaments to craft delightful, self-contained green spaces, perfect for balconies or windowsills.
- 2 The humble art of 'sketching daily moments' is being embraced by many as a mindful way to appreciate the everyday.**
From a quick doodle of a morning cuppa to a detailed sketch of a local landmark, people are discovering the calm and creativity in capturing fleeting observations with a pencil and paper.
- 3 A new appreciation for 'vintage board games' is sweeping through households, offering a nostalgic and screen-free way to connect.**
Families and friends are dusting off classic games like Monopoly and Cluedo, enjoying the simple pleasure of strategic play and friendly competition.
- 4 Research highlights the positive impact of 'sending handwritten letters' on both the sender and receiver's well-being.**
Taking the time to craft a personal message and send it through the post is proving to be a heartfelt way to maintain connections and spread a little joy.
- 5 The delightful pastime of 'foraging for wild berries' is experiencing a resurgence in popularity across the countryside.**
Armed with baskets and guides, enthusiasts are enjoying walks in nature while gathering delicious wild edibles, perfect for jams and crumbles.
- 6 A charming new study suggests that 'whistling a happy tune' can genuinely improve your mood and reduce stress.**
It seems the simple act of puckering up and letting out a melody can be a surprising little pick-me-up for your day.
- 7 British parks are reporting a rise in 'outdoor yoga sessions', as people seek fresh air for their stretches.**
Practising yoga amidst nature, with the sounds of birds and the feel of grass beneath, is becoming a popular way to find peace and fitness.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: SMELLING THEM VERY INTENTLY, HOPING TO DIVINE THEIR DELICIOUSNESS BY SCENT ALONE.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new book, especially if it's a much-anticipated release. What is it?

ANSWER: GENTLY FLEXING THE SPINE OF THE BOOK A FEW TIMES, AS IF LIMBERING IT UP FOR THE READING MARATHON AHEAD.

TALK TOPIC

- We all have that 'one particular piece of clothing' that, no matter how old it gets or how many times it's been washed, you just can't bring yourself to part with because it holds so many happy memories, don't we?

What's that treasured item in your wardrobe, and what makes it so special to you? Give us a call!

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of weather' just instantly lifts your spirits, whether it's the crispness of an autumn day or the warmth of a summer breeze?

What's your absolute favourite kind of weather, and what do you love to do when it arrives? We'd love to hear from you!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** The London Underground escalators actually outnumber the tube trains in operation.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first traffic light system in the world was installed outside the Houses of Parliament in London, but it exploded after just one month.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as 3D wallpaper.
- The shortest complete English sentence is 'I am'.
- The world's largest actively growing coral reef is the Great Barrier Reef, off the coast of Queensland, Australia.
- Humans share 50% of their DNA with bananas.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis in Scotland.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, which is roughly the same as 100 elephants.

On this day

Day 264 of the year, 101 days left in 2026. Today Autumnal equinox observances in the Northern Hemisphere, vernal equinox observances in the Southern Hemisphere (see September 22): Spring Day (Argentina); Christian feast day: Cadoc; Christian feast day: Ephigenia of Ethiopia; Christian feast day: Laurent-Joseph-Marius Imbert (one of the Korean Martyrs). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Rose Garrard, English sculptor and author
- 1968 — David Jude Jolicoeur, American rapper, songwriter, and producer (died 2023)
- 1940 — Ron Fenton, English footballer, coach, and manager (died 2013)
- 1983 — Maggie Grace, American actress
- 1979 — James Allan, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — Billy Porter, American actor and singer
- 1981 — Sarah Whatmore, English singer-songwriter
- 1972 — Liam Gallagher, English singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1971 — Bahrain, Bhutan and Qatar join the United Nations.
- 2001 — Ross Parker is murdered in Peterborough, England, by a gang of ten British Pakistani youths.
- 1976 — Seychelles joins the United Nations.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1972 — Philippine president Ferdinand Marcos begins authoritarian rule by declaring martial law.
- 1981 — Sandra Day O'Connor is unanimously approved by the U.S. Senate as the first female Supreme Court justice.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2013 — Al-Shabaab Islamic militants attack the Westgate shopping mall in Kenya, killing at least 67 people.
- 1977 — Malév Flight 203 crashes near Urziceni, killing 29 people.
- 2019 — A 5.6 Mw earthquake shakes the Albanian port of Durrës. Forty-nine people are injured in the capital, Tirana.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 265 of the year, 100 days left in 2026. Today American Business Women's Day (United States); Baltic Unity Day (Lithuania, Latvia); Christian feast days: Digna and Emerita; Christian feast days: Emmeram of Regensburg. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Luther Reigns, American actor and wrestler
- 1944 — Brian Gibson, English director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2004)
- 1930 — Joni James, American singer (died 2022)
- 1982 — Billie Piper, English actress and singer
- 1967 — Matt Besser, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1957 — Johnette Napolitano, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1966 — Ruth Jones, Welsh actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1965 — Dan Bucatinsky, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1965 — The Indo-Pakistani War of 1965 between India and Pakistan over Kashmir ends after the United Nations calls for a ceasefire and after a last engagement near Dograi.
- 1914 — A German submarine sinks three British cruisers over a seventy-minute period, killing almost 1,500 sailors.
- 1953 — The Four Level Interchange, first stack interchange in the world opened in Los Angeles.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1995 — An E-3B AWACS crashes outside Elmendorf Air Force Base, Alaska after multiple bird strikes to two of the four engines soon after takeoff; all 24 on board are killed.
- 1914 — A German submarine sinks three British cruisers over a seventy-minute period, killing almost 1,500 sailors.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar